

FUTURE SKILLS SERIES

AI Literacy • Lesson 2 of 6

THE TRAINING DATA LESSON

What's in the Playlist?

Gap in the playlist, **gap** in the AI.

Grades 6–8

45-min lesson

No prep • No devices needed



STUDENT SESSION

Playlist Check



Name: _____ Partner: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

You two take turns being the AI. The playlist below is its **training data**: every song it has ever "heard." Partner A is the partner whose first name comes first in the alphabet. **Partner A starts as the App** and picks the song. **Partner B starts as the Caller** and reads each request out loud. Swap jobs after request #3. To **serve** a song, point to a card and say its title. Three rules:

- **Rule 1:** Only serve cards from the playlist. No inventing songs mid-game.
- **Rule 2:** Never say no. Serve the closest card you've got. A music app always gives you *something*.
- **Rule 3:** Check ONE Fit box (Perfect / Kind of / Nothing) honestly, on your own sheet. Your check marks are your evidence for the Gap Report.

THE PLAYLIST — ALL 12 SONGS YOU KNOW (ALL IN ENGLISH)

Thunder Mode Hype Trap · Fast · Party	Bass Quake Electro Party · Fast · Party	Level Up Anthem Hype Trap · Fast · Gym	Full On Press Stadium Hype · Fast · Sports
Neon Stampede Electro Party · Fast · Party	Turbo Turbo Electro Party · Fast · Gym	Crowd Goes Wild Stadium Hype · Fast · Sports	Volume War Hype Trap · Fast · Party
Midnight Sprint Electro Party · Fast · Gym	Glow Up Tonight Party Pop · Fast · Party	Confetti Cannon Party Pop · Fast · Party	Cool Down (Kinda) Party Pop · Medium · Party

Hype = loud and exciting. Read all 12 cards first. Every song I know is _____ and _____.

SERVE THE CALLER

Caller reads the request. App chooses the best card. Both of you write the card and check ONE Fit box on your own sheet.

REQUEST	BEST CARD IN YOUR PLAYLIST	PERFECT FIT	KIND OF FITS	NOTHING FITS
1. Nia needs a hype song for when the basketball team runs onto the court.		☐	☐	☐
2. Nia wants something calm to study to before the math test.		☐	☐	☐
3. Tomás wants a song in Spanish for his abuela's (grandma's) birthday dinner.		☐	☐	☐
4. Keisha wants a slow song for the last dance at the 8th-grade dance. (Swap jobs first!)		☐	☐	☐
5. Malik wants a first song for his party — one that makes everyone jump at once.		☐	☐	☐
6. Jordan wants a quiet guitar song for a sing-along at the talent show.		☐	☐	☐
7. The pair beside you makes up ONE request for your app. (The pair closer to the door goes first.) Write it:		☐	☐	☐

THE TRAINING DATA LESSON • LESSON 2 OF 6

What's in the Playlist?



How AI learns, and where bias comes from. An AI is a music app and its training data is the playlist. A one-vibe playlist gets one-vibe answers. Stands alone.

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min	Playlist Check worksheet, 2 pages, 1 per student — each fills their OWN sheet (typeable PDF copy included) · Slides (optional; script in the notes) · board	None — runs fully unplugged. Optional: a projector for the deck	Print worksheets. That's it.

OBJECTIVES

- Explain how an AI learns: **input** → **patterns** → **output** — prediction from data, not magic. (*Exit Ticket #1*)
- Name who a dataset serves well and who it leaves out; link that gap to real AI bias. (*Gap Report, Slide #2*)
- Discuss data gaps with a partner: say their idea back, then add to it. (*Repeat, Then Add*)

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

CSTA 2-IC-21

ISTE 1.1.d

CCSS ELA SL.6.1

Full text: Teacher Guide, p.3

DIFFERENTIATION

- Support:** Gray sentence starters on the worksheet; mark-card tip in the Teacher Guide, p.2.
- Extension:** Design a 12-card playlist that serves every request on the sheet, then defend the tradeoffs. Model answer: Teacher Guide, p.3.
- ELL:** Fit marks are check boxes, not sentences. New cards can be in any language, which fixes a real gap.
- No-device classroom:** Built in — the lesson is paper, pairs, and one loud imaginary music app.

WARM-UP: THE ONE-PLAYLIST APP (7 MIN)

You are AutoMix, the school's new music app. Your playlist holds one kind of song: loud, fast party tracks. Take 3 requests and serve every one with total confidence:

"Something chill to study to?" → "Here's 'TURBO TURBO.' It is not chill. It's what I've got."

"A song for grandma's birthday dinner?" → "Got it. 'VOLUME WAR.' Grandma loves bass drops, probably."

"A slow song for the last dance?" → "'NEON STAMPEDE,' played at... the exact same speed."

Then ask: **"Is AutoMix bad at picking songs — or is something else broken?"** Fish for it. The app is doing its job. The *playlist* is the problem.

If nobody gets there: "Could AutoMix play a slow song if it had one?" Yes — the app works. So what's missing?

Bridge: "If you did the genie lesson, you saw an AI grant what you SAID. If you didn't, no problem. Here's today's question: where do an AI's answers come from in the first place? What an AI 'knows' comes from a playlist of examples. That's its training data. It can remix the playlist. It can't serve what was never in it. Today you'll BE the app."

Transition: "So what IS in an AI's playlist, and what does it do with it? Three words on the board."

WHEN IT GOES SIDEWAYS

"Did someone do this on purpose?" → Usually not. Teams collect the data that's easiest to get, and easy data leans toward whoever shows up most. No villain required — which is why good AI teams audit their playlists before shipping.

A pair argues about a Fit box → each checks their own box on their own sheet. Disagreement is data — bring it to the debrief: "Two honest raters, two answers. What does that tell you about the playlist?"

A pair writes "it needs more songs" → ask WHO asked for something that wasn't there. The standard (2-IC-21) is about people, not song counts.

Every new card is a slow song → "Which request still has nothing? Tomás?" Push for a different gap per card. If asked **"isn't AI creative?"** → it can mash up playlist patterns into new combos, but not a genre it has never heard.

EXTENSION KEY

A strong 12-card playlist keeps a handful of hype tracks, so Priya and Malik still get a Perfect fit, and spends the freed slots on the gaps: something calm for Nia, something slow for Keisha, Spanish tracks for Tomás, quiet guitar for Jordan. Look for a tradeoff sentence like "I cut six party tracks, so Malik has fewer picks, but every request now gets a real song."

FULL STANDARDS TEXT

- **CSTA 2-IC-21** — Discuss issues of bias and accessibility in the design of existing technologies. *Taught: Playlist Check gap-mapping + Real Playlists debrief (bias: accents, skin tone; accessibility: speech differences). Assessed: Gap Report Q2, Exit Ticket #2.*
- **ISTE 1.1.d** — Students understand the fundamental concepts of technology operations, demonstrate the ability to choose, use and troubleshoot current technologies and are able to transfer their knowledge to explore emerging technologies. *Taught: No Magic in the Machine (input → patterns → output). Assessed: Exit Ticket #1, transfer to a new tool in Exit Ticket #2.*
- **CCSS.ELA SL.6.1** — Engage effectively in a range of collaborative discussions (one-on-one, in groups, and teacher-led) with diverse partners on grade 6 topics, texts, and issues, building on others' ideas and expressing their own clearly. *Taught: the repeat-then-add rule in Playlist Check step 3. Assessed: the Repeat, Then Add lines (worksheet p.2).*

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